

Business

1. Tesla has spent two years watching its sales slide, taking flak over Elon Musk's political adventures and losing ground in key markets. So how did its Q2 2025 deliveries actually come in?
 - a. A record Q2, with growth driven largely by recovering European demand
 - b. A modest miss on Wall Street estimates, blamed on North American weakness
 - c. A flat quarter, held up only by aggressive price cuts in China
2. The US car market recently split sharply in two. Automakers with one particular type of vehicle in their lineup largely outperformed those without it in Q2 2025. Which type?
 - a. Fully electric vehicles
 - b. Hybrid vehicles
 - c. Large pickup trucks
3. Scandinavian airline SAS emerged from bankruptcy just two years ago. This month it placed the largest order in its entire history — a striking show of confidence from a carrier that was recently on its knees. What did it order, and for how much?
 - a. Up to 40 Airbus widebody jets worth around €8.75 billion
 - b. A fleet of 25 Boeing narrowbody aircraft worth around €4 billion
 - c. 60 Airbus short-haul jets worth €6.5 billion, with options for 20 more
4. A new federal financial disclosure revealed this month that someone in the White House made around \$1.2 billion from cryptocurrency ventures in his first year back in office — while ordinary investors in the very same tokens lost money. Who?
 - a. JD Vance, via family trusts set up before taking office
 - b. Donald Trump, through his family's crypto business
 - c. Elon Musk, from meme coin promotions on social media

Economics

5. Spain's unemployment (the number of people registered as jobseekers) just hit its lowest level since January 2008. The headline figure dropped to 2,291,982 in June. Why does the January 2008 comparison matter so much?
 - a. 2008 was the last time Spain ran a budget surplus, making it a benchmark for fiscal health
 - b. January 2008 was just before the global financial crisis cratered Spain's economy and sent unemployment soaring
 - c. Spain changed how it counts unemployment in 2008, so the figures are only comparable from that point

6. The US Federal Reserve (the central bank that sets American interest rates) is expected to decide on a possible rate change within four weeks, according to senior Fed official Kevin Warsh. Which of these is NOT currently cited as a risk shaping that decision?
 - a. Energy prices pushing inflation higher
 - b. A surge in AI-driven business investment adding to demand in the economy
 - c. A sharp rise in US household savings reducing consumer spending
7. Iran's rial (its national currency) has recently fallen to record lows amid rising military tensions in the Persian Gulf. What is the most direct consequence for ordinary Iranians?
 - a. A surge in inflation making basic necessities harder to afford, hitting the poorest hardest
 - b. A collapse in oil export revenues, forcing the government to cut public sector wages
 - c. A banking crisis as foreign-currency debts become impossible to repay
8. Wall Street's 'Magnificent Seven' — the group of mega-cap (very large) US tech companies including Apple, Nvidia and Microsoft — have dominated stock market returns for years. How bad was their worst recent stretch?
 - a. They underperformed the broader market for three months running in early 2025
 - b. They posted their worst single month in years this June, as investors rotated away from AI-spending stocks
 - c. Two of the seven posted losses for the full first half of 2025

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of cobalt — the metal that is essential for the batteries used in electric vehicles and smartphones?
 - a. Chile
 - b. Democratic Republic of Congo
 - c. Indonesia
10. Which economist, working in 18th-century Scotland, wrote the book now considered the founding text of modern economics — arguing that free markets and the division of labour were the engines of national wealth?
 - a. David Ricardo
 - b. John Maynard Keynes
 - c. Adam Smith

Business

1. Tesla has spent two years watching its sales slide, taking flak over Elon Musk's political adventures and losing ground in key markets. So how did its Q2 2025 deliveries actually come in?
 - a. *Tesla posted a record Q2, beating Wall Street estimates as European demand bounced back strongly. It marked the first annual sales growth after two consecutive years of decline — a notable turnaround for a brand that had become a political lightning rod. North American demand remained soft, suggesting the recovery is still uneven.*
 2. The US car market recently split sharply in two. Automakers with one particular type of vehicle in their lineup largely outperformed those without it in Q2 2025. Which type?
 - b. *Hybrids are driving the performance divide across the US auto industry right now. Brands with strong hybrid ranges — think Toyota — are pulling ahead, while those that bet heavily on pure electric or stuck with traditional combustion engines are struggling. It suggests consumers want cleaner cars but aren't ready to go fully electric yet.*
 3. Scandinavian airline SAS emerged from bankruptcy just two years ago. This month it placed the largest order in its entire history — a striking show of confidence from a carrier that was recently on its knees. What did it order, and for how much?
 - a. *SAS agreed to buy up to 40 Airbus widebody jets in a deal worth over €8.75 billion — the biggest order in the airline's history. The timing is striking: just two years out of bankruptcy protection, SAS is now betting heavily on long-haul recovery. Widebody jets are the big intercontinental planes; they cost hundreds of millions each and take years to deliver.*
 4. A new federal financial disclosure revealed this month that someone in the White House made around \$1.2 billion from cryptocurrency ventures in his first year back in office — while ordinary investors in the very same tokens lost money. Who?
 - b. *Donald Trump earned roughly \$1.2 billion (about €1.05bn) from his family's cryptocurrency ventures in his first year back in the White House, according to federal disclosure filings. The kicker: retail investors who bought the same tokens — including Trump-branded meme coins — largely lost money on them. It is probably the most unusual presidential income disclosure in American history.*
- ## Economics
5. Spain's unemployment (the number of people registered as jobseekers) just hit its lowest level since January 2008. The headline figure dropped to 2,291,982 in June. Why does the January 2008 comparison matter so much?
 - b. *January 2008 was the last calm moment before the global financial crisis hit Spain with devastating force. Unemployment eventually peaked above 26% in 2013 — one in four workers — making it one of the worst labour market collapses in any developed economy. Falling back below 2.3 million registered jobseekers is a genuine milestone, even if Spain's labour market still has structural weaknesses.*

6. The US Federal Reserve (the central bank that sets American interest rates) is expected to decide on a possible rate change within four weeks, according to senior Fed official Kevin Warsh. Which of these is NOT currently cited as a risk shaping that decision?
 - c. *A surge in household savings is not among the risks the Fed is wrestling with right now. The live concerns are energy prices — which feed directly into inflation (the rate at which prices rise across the economy) — and a boom in AI-related capital spending, which could overheat demand. Higher savings would actually cool inflation, which is the opposite of the Fed's current worry.*
 7. Iran's rial (its national currency) has recently fallen to record lows amid rising military tensions in the Persian Gulf. What is the most direct consequence for ordinary Iranians?
 - a. *When a currency collapses, imports become dramatically more expensive almost overnight — and that feeds straight into the price of food, medicine and fuel. Iran's inflation (the rate at which prices are rising) has spiked sharply, with low-income households and rural communities bearing the worst of it because they spend a higher share of their income on basic goods. Currency crises almost always hurt the poorest first.*
 8. Wall Street's 'Magnificent Seven' — the group of mega-cap (very large) US tech companies including Apple, Nvidia and Microsoft — have dominated stock market returns for years. How bad was their worst recent stretch?
 - b. *June 2025 was the Magnificent Seven's worst month in years, a sharp reversal for a group that had seemed unstoppable. Investors appear to be questioning whether the enormous sums being spent on AI infrastructure will actually translate into profits — and quietly moving money elsewhere. When the stocks that drove the whole market higher start sliding, it tends to get people's attention fast.*
- ## General Knowledge
9. Which country is the world's largest producer of cobalt — the metal that is essential for the batteries used in electric vehicles and smartphones?
 - b. *The Democratic Republic of Congo produces roughly 70% of the world's cobalt, making it the single most important country in the supply chain for modern batteries. This gives the DRC enormous strategic importance — and significant leverage — in the global shift to electric vehicles, even as it remains one of the poorest countries on earth. Geopolitics around critical minerals is one of the defining economic stories of the decade.*
 10. Which economist, working in 18th-century Scotland, wrote the book now considered the founding text of modern economics — arguing that free markets and the division of labour were the engines of national wealth?
 - c. *Adam Smith published 'The Wealth of Nations' in 1776 — the same year as the American Declaration of Independence, which is a coincidence economists love to mention. His argument that individuals pursuing their own interests can, through the 'invisible hand' of the market, produce outcomes that benefit society as a whole remains one of the most influential ideas in the history of human thought.*